INTRODUCTION

We are passing through an era of ‘technology vs environment’ dilemma. Never before has so much attention been given to the issue of the ***‘relationship between environment & technology’*** . While humanity continued realising higher growth and development on the ‘vibes’ of newer technologies; scholars remained busy debating the issues like – whether technologies are neutral, promote happiness or cause environmental degradation. We are at crossroads where shortcuts are available at every step, but there lacks an alternative technology which can promote its growth and developmental requirements and eventually doesn’t threaten its habitat, surrounding, ecology and the environment. Global as well as individual attempts are in place but it is probably not possible to put a timeframe in which mankind will be able to solve the dilemma. This chapter is devoted to understanding this dilemma. All contemporary views of experts, together with the official stand of the major nations of the world, including India, have been included in the discussion.

TECHNOLOGY – THE TRADITIONAL VIEW

The old view about technological development was that they came into being through chance discoveries from the works of independent scientists and engineers. It was assumed that such discoveries are then applied if they increase industrial productivity, meet market demands and increase profits. In this way, inventions lead to innovations, innovations lead to the diffusion of technological products. In the history of technology, key points of interest have been, ***who the inventors were***, when they made their invention and on what scientific or technological advance the invention was based. Occasionally, attention is turned to why some inventions fail to make it as commercial technologies and what the barriers to that progression may be. Technology is therefore seen as merely the fruits of applied science.

By one view, technology is *neutral* and that is why techniques pursue no end in itself.[1] However, this view has been discredited by modern scholars who opine that the progress toward the wide adoption of a technology is